

The diagnosis of a child with a serious disability significantly impacts the child's parents. While positive psychological outcomes are sometimes possible, evidenced by research showing that for some parents a child's disability is eventually viewed as a chance for personal growth, research also indicates that many parents of children with disabilities are at greater risk for poor physical and mental health outcomes. Coping with a child's initial symptoms, providing ongoing care, and dealing with prejudice from others present significant stressors for parents. This stress may also disrupt marriages; results of a meta-analysis showed a modest, increased risk for divorce in parents of children with disabilities. Another line of research has identified significantly higher rates of anxiety and/or depression in parents of children with disabilities. The fact that parental distress often results in poorer outcomes for their children points to a need for evidence-based interventions for parents of children with disabilities.

In Study 1, researchers compared the effectiveness of two interventions in reducing depressive symptoms in parents of children with cognitive disabilities. Researchers recruited 30 parents of children with intellectual disorders from the contact list of an affluent community wellness center and randomly assigned them to a meditation (M) group or a humanistic psychotherapy (HP) group. Both groups were led by peer mentors trained in specific interventions who taught and demonstrated the techniques to the participants during the weekly sessions. Participants completed self-report measures of depressive symptoms at baseline (pre-test), 4 weeks into the intervention (midpoint), at the end of the 8-week program (post-test 1), and 4 weeks after the program ended (post-test 2). The findings are shown in Figure 1.

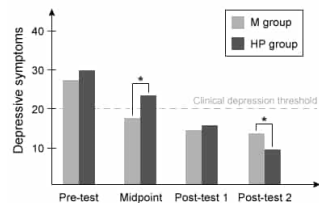


Figure 1 Depressive symptoms at pre-test, midpoint, post-test 1, and post-test 2 (Note: * indicates $p < .05$.)

In Study 2, researchers examined the impact of coping strategies on distress in 80 parents of children with muscular dystrophy. Participants were asked to think of a recent stressful, threatening event and report whether they had classified their future expectancy for the event as "changeable" (situation is able to be modified) or "unchangeable" (situation is not able to be modified). They were then asked whether they attempted to cope with the event primarily by regulating their emotions (emotion-focused) or by modifying aspects of the situation (problem-focused), such as seeking help from others. Lastly, they were surveyed about their level of distress after they tried to cope with the stressor. Figure 2 illustrates the findings.

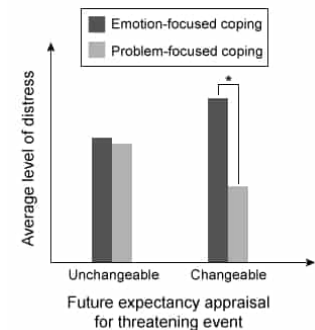


Figure 2 Average level of distress by coping strategy (emotion-focused vs. problem-focused) and future expectancy appraisal for the threatening event (Note: * indicates $p < .05$.)

Which of the following provides a potential explanation for the increased risk for divorce (first paragraph) that is based on the concept of role conflict? Parents of children with disabilities:

- ☐ A. struggle to fulfill the numerous, competing duties of parenting a child with a disability. [19%]
- ☐ B. are exempted from societal roles and expectations if they have depression and/or anxiety.
- ☒ C. experience tension between their expectations as a parent and as a spouse. [71%]
- ☐ D. internalize perceived prejudice from others, leading to feelings of inadequacy in their role as parent. [8%]

Correct
71% answered correctly

Explanation:

Elements of social interaction: Roles	
Role strain	- Competing expectations within a single role create tension - eg, a student struggles to find enough time to complete homework (expectation 1) & attend student government meetings (expectation 2)
Role conflict	- Competing expectations for two or more roles create tension - eg, a student (role 1) who is employed part-time (role 2) struggles to find enough time to complete homework & work late hours
Role exit	- Individual disengages from a social role, often replacing it with a new social role - eg, a college student (old role) graduates & begins full-time employment (new role)

Social institutions (eg, family) are enduring, organized systems that outline behavioral norms and fulfill a purpose in society. Families include at least two individuals who typically live together and are connected by an intimate relationship (eg, marriage/partnership, birth, adoption).

Marriage is viewed in most societies as an **official union** between two adults conferring certain legal and social rights and duties. **Divorce** is an **official dissolution** of a **marriage**.

Social roles encompass the behavior expected of individuals in social situations. **Role conflict** occurs when **expectations** for **two or more roles** simultaneously held by an individual are in competition, producing **tension**.

The tension that parents experience between their expectations as a parent (eg, parental role) and as a spouse (eg, spousal role) is a potential explanation for the increased risk for divorce based on the concept of role conflict.

(Choice A) Role strain occurs when a single role involves multiple competing expectations that produce tension. Struggling to fulfill numerous, competing duties of parenting a child with a disability is a potential explanation based on the concept of *role strain*, not role conflict.

(Choice B) Sick role theory posits that when someone is ill, they have certain rights (eg, exemption from work) and obligations (eg, seeking medical attention). Exemption from societal roles and expectations as a result of depression/anxiety is a potential explanation based on *sick role theory*, not role conflict.

(Choice D) Looking-glass self suggests that our interpretation of how we are perceived by others impacts our self-concept (beliefs about ourselves). Feeling inadequate as a parent based on internalized perceived prejudice from others is a potential explanation based on *looking-glass self*, not role conflict.

Educational objective:

Marriage is an official union between two adults conferring legal and social rights; divorce is an official dissolution of a marriage. Role conflict occurs when expectations for two simultaneously held social roles compete, producing tension.

Time spent:0 sec
Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:402398
System:
Motivation, Emotion, Attitudes, Personality, and Stress

The diagnosis of a child with a serious disability significantly impacts the child's parents. While positive psychological outcomes are sometimes possible, evidenced by research showing that for some parents a child's disability is eventually viewed as a chance for personal growth, research also indicates that many parents of children with disabilities are at greater risk for poor physical and mental health outcomes. Coping with a child's initial symptoms, providing ongoing care, and dealing with prejudice from others present significant stressors for parents. This stress may also disrupt marriages; results of a meta-analysis showed a modest, increased risk for divorce in parents of children with disabilities. Another line of research has identified significantly higher rates of anxiety and/or depression in parents of children with disabilities. The fact that parental distress often results in poorer outcomes for their children points to a need for evidence-based interventions for parents of children with disabilities.

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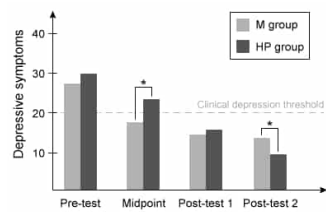


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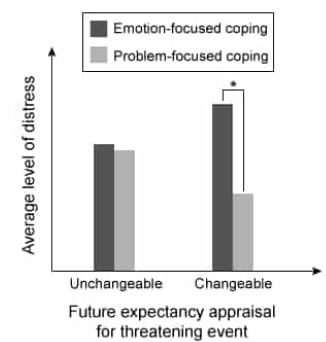


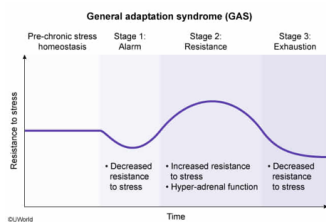
Figure 2 Average level of distress by coping strategy (emotion-focused vs. problem-focused) and future expectancy appraisal for the threatening event (Note: * indicates $p < .05$.)

Which statement most accurately applies the general adaptation syndrome to the stress associated with parenting children with disabilities (first paragraph)?

- ☐ A. The stress resulting from the prejudice of others would not impact physiological processes because it is a social stressor. [1%]
- ☐ B. At the first onset of a child's symptoms, parents experience increased resistance to stress. [18%]
- ☐ C. The psychological impact of parenting a child with a serious disability will be similar for all parents. [15%]
- ☒ D. As a child's medical condition continues over a prolonged period, parents experience decreased resistance to stress. [64%]

Correct
65% answered correctly

Explanation:



The **general adaptation syndrome** (GAS), proposed by Hans Selye, is a model describing how the body **reacts to stress**. According to this model, there are three stages of the stress response:

- The **alarm stage** occurs during the first few minutes of the stress response, in which the sympathetic nervous system prepares the body to act (ie, fight-or-flight response).
- The **resistance stage** can last for hours (eg, exercise), days (eg, final exams), or months (eg, preparing for the MCAT). During this stage, the body attempts to resist the stressor and establish a new equilibrium.
- The **exhaustion stage** occurs when prolonged stress produces arousal with depleted energy, making the body more vulnerable to negative health effects (eg, depression, hypertension).

As a child's medical condition continues over a prolonged period, parents typically move into the exhaustion stage, according to the general adaptation syndrome, where they will experience *decreased resistance to stress*.

(Choice A) According to the GAS, the stress response follows a similar pattern over time, regardless of the type of stressor. Therefore, the stress resulting from the prejudice of others *would* impact physiological processes as the type of stressor (ie, social) is irrelevant.

(Choice B) In the alarm stage, the first onset of a child's symptoms, parents should experience decreased (not increased) resistance to stress.

(Choice C) The passage states that some parents eventually experience positive psychological outcomes while others experience negative mental health outcomes (eg, depression, anxiety). Therefore, the psychological impact of parenting a child with a serious disability will vary among individuals and is not necessarily similar for all parents.

Educational objective:

According to the general adaptation syndrome, the body's response to stress involves an alarm stage (initial fight-or-flight response), resistance stage (increased resistance to stress), and exhaustion stage (eventual decreased resistance to stress) that may lead to the development of mental and physical health issues. Although most stressors elicit similar physiologic stress response course over time, not all individuals experience negative mental outcomes.

Time spent:0 sec
Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:402399
System:
Motivation, Emotion, Attitudes, Personality, and Stress

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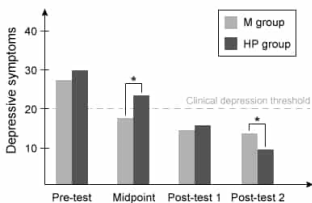


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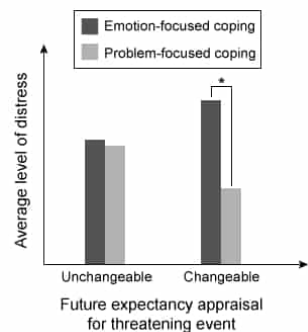


Figure 2 Average level of distress by coping strategy (emotion-focused vs. problem-focused) and future expectancy appraisal for the threatening event (Note: * indicates $p < .05$.)

The HP group peer mentor would have been most likely to have participants focus on:

- ☒ A. accepting the circumstances of their child's condition and pursuing personal growth. [60%]
- ☐ B. replacing negative, maladaptive thoughts with positive, adaptive thoughts. [18%]
- ☐ C. uncovering unconscious conflicts and feelings about their child's condition. [17%]
- ☐ D. treating underlying physiological causes of their depression before engaging in therapy. [3%]

Correct

59% answered correctly

Explanation:

Major psychotherapeutic approaches		
Cognitive-behavioral therapy (CBT)	Psychoanalytic therapy ("talk therapy")	Humanistic therapy (person-centered therapy)
Attempts to change negative thoughts/beliefs (cognitions) & maladaptive behaviors	Attempts to uncover how unconscious conflicts rooted in childhood shape behaviors	Attempts to empower individual to move toward self-actualization
Various techniques (eg. desensitization, self-talk) used to replace destructive thoughts/behaviors with healthy ones	Various techniques (eg. free association, dream analysis) used to analyze unconscious	Unconditional positive regard & empathy used to encourage client to reach full potential

Humanistic psychology emphasizes the **higher aspects** of **human nature**, including the drive toward **self-actualization** (ie, achieving one's full potential) and **personal growth**.

Humanistic psychologists take an optimistic view of human nature, believing that people have an innate drive toward self-improvement. Humanistic psychotherapy utilizes a person- or client-centered approach (the word "patient" is not used), so the intervention is unique to the individual.

Therefore, participants in the HP group, guided by humanistic psychology interventions from their peer mentor, would have most likely focused on accepting the circumstances of their child's condition and pursuing personal growth.

(Choice B) Cognitive-behavioral therapy attempts to replace negative thoughts and behaviors with healthier thoughts and behaviors. The HP group participants would not have focused on replacing maladaptive thoughts with adaptive ones (a cognitive-behavioral approach).

(Choice C) The psychodynamic approach focuses on revealing the unconscious and on understanding how previous conflict influences the present. The HP group participants would not have focused on uncovering unconscious conflicts and feelings about their child's condition (a psychodynamic approach).

(Choice D) The biomedical approach views physiological causes (eg, abnormal brain chemistry) as the basis for psychological symptoms, emphasizing treatment with medical interventions (eg, medication). The HP group participants would not have focused on treating underlying physiological causes (a biomedical approach).

Educational objective:

Humanistic psychology takes an optimistic approach, emphasizing the positive and creative aspects of human nature. It asserts that individuals strive toward self-actualization (fullest potential) and personal growth.

Time spent:0 sec
Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID:402400
System:
Motivation, Emotion, Attitudes, Personality, and Stress

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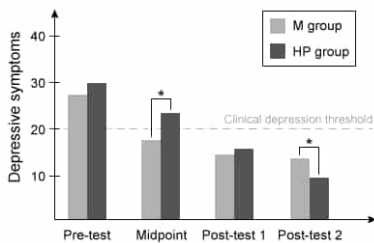


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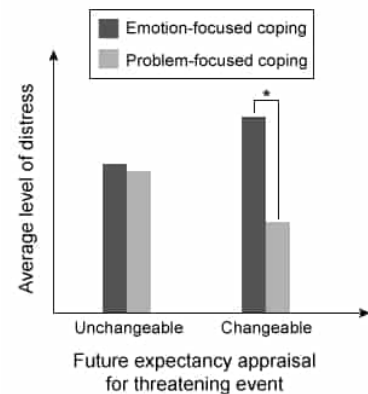


Figure 2 Average level of distress by coping strategy (emotion-focused vs. problem-focused) and future expectancy appraisal for the threatening event (Note: * indicates $p < .05$.)

Which statement is best supported by Figure 1?

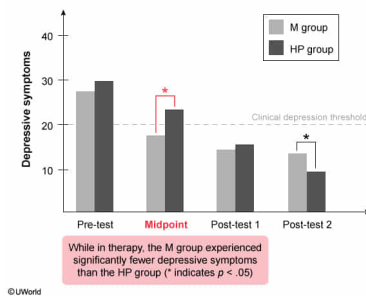
- ☐ A. Depressive symptoms in the M group continued to decline after the discontinuation of therapy. [4%]
- ☒ B. While in therapy, the M group experienced fewer depressive symptoms compared to the HP group. [70%]
- ☐ C. Both M and HP therapies resulted in similar levels of depressive symptoms at post-test 2. [1%]

☐ D. At baseline, the HP group had higher levels of depressive symptoms compared to the M group. [22%]

Correct

71% answered correctly

Explanation:



Relaxation is a physiological state of reduced arousal and sympathetic activity. Research indicates that relaxation, which can be achieved through many different techniques (eg, massage, meditation), is effective for reducing stress.

Meditation is a practice whereby individuals **regulate** their **awareness** and **attention** with the goal of achieving mental clarity and emotional calmness. Although meditation techniques vary, they can include focusing on one's own breathing or other present-moment stimuli (eg, the sound of rain), or mentally repeating a mantra (short saying or thought). Neuroimaging studies have shown that meditation not only results in relaxation, but also produces an altered state of consciousness, demonstrated by an increase in alpha **brain waves**. Regular meditation provides benefits outside of the meditative state, such as improved attention and emotional self-regulation.

Depressive symptoms were measured only once *during* the therapeutic intervention, at the midpoint (ie, halfway through). Figure 1, which shows that the M group had significantly fewer depressive symptoms than the HP group (as indicated by the asterisks) at the midpoint, supports the statement that while *in therapy*, the M group experienced fewer depressive symptoms compared to the HP group.

(Choice A) The M group had **approximately similar** (not reduced) levels of depressive symptoms from post-test 1 to post-test 2.

(Choice C) Although the M and HP therapies resulted in similar levels of depressive symptoms at post-test 1, the HP group showed **significantly fewer** depressive symptoms than the M group at post-test 2 (as indicated by the asterisks between post-test 2 scores in Figure 1).

(Choice D) There was **no significant difference** in the level of depressive symptoms at baseline between the two groups (no asterisks between pre-test scores in Figure 1), so the statement that the HP group had higher levels of depressive symptoms at baseline as compared to the M group is not supported.

Educational objective:

Meditation is a relaxation technique whereby individuals regulate their awareness and attention. Meditation may improve mental clarity and emotional calmness. Regular meditation provides benefits outside of the meditative state, such as improved attention and emotional self-regulation.

Time spent: 0 sec

Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID: 402401

System:
Motivation, Emotion, Attitudes, Personality, and Stress

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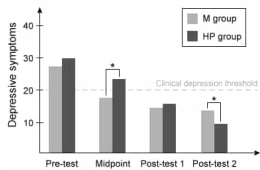


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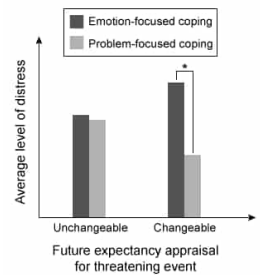


Figure 2 Average level of distress by coping strategy (emotion-focused vs. problem-focused) and future expectancy appraisal for the threatening event (Note: * indicates $p < .05$.)

A researcher criticizes Study 1, claiming that nonrepresentative sampling led to results that may not apply to many families of children with disabilities. This criticism is most concerned with:

- ☐ A. Internal validity [7%]
- ☐ B. Reliability [7%]
- ☐ C. Confounding variables [6%]
- ☒ D. Generalizability [78%]

Correct
77% answered correctly

Explanation:

	Internal validity	External validity
Describes:	Causality If a change in the independent variable is truly causing a change in the dependent variable	Generalizability If the observed relationship exists outside the experiment to another situation or other people
Major threats to:	• Confounding variables • Selection bias • Maturation • Regression toward the mean	• Artificial research environment • Nonrepresentative samples • Measurement effects
As experiment becomes more tightly controlled:	↑	↓
As experiment becomes more like the real world:	↓	↑

A variety of criteria are used to judge the extent to which scientific findings are credible (ie, can be trusted or believed). **External validity** is concerned with **generalizability**, or the extent to which results can be **applied to other situations** (eg, outside the laboratory) or **people** (eg, to the population). If a study's sample is not representative of the population, its findings will likely not apply to that population because they differ in some way.

A researcher's assertion that nonrepresentative sampling (ie, from an affluent community wellness center) led to findings that do not apply to all families of children with disabilities is concerned with **generalizability**.

(Choice A) Internal validity is mostly concerned with causality, the extent to which changes in the dependent variable can be attributed to changes in the independent variable. A researcher's assertion that findings may not apply to all families of children with disabilities is concerned with **generalizability**, not internal validity.

(Choice B) Reliability refers to the ability of an experiment or measure to produce similar results every time (eg, two IQ tests taken months apart by the same person should yield a similar result). A researcher's assertion that findings may not apply to all families of children with disabilities is concerned with **generalizability**, not reliability.

(Choice C) Confounding variables are additional variables that influence the independent and/or dependent variable. A researcher's assertion that findings may not apply to all families of children with disabilities is concerned with **generalizability**, not confounding variables.

Educational objective:

External validity, also known as generalizability, is the extent to which study results can be applied to other situations or people.

Time spent: 0 sec
Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

QID: 402402
System:
Motivation, Emotion, Attitudes, Personality, and Stress

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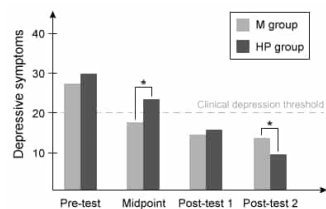


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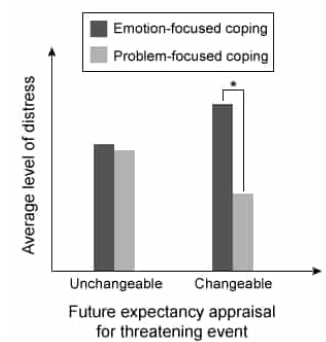


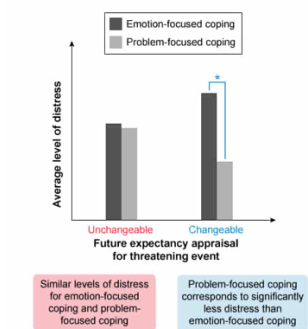
Figure 2 Average level of distress by coping strategy (emotion-focused vs. problem-focused) and future expectancy appraisal for the threatening event (Note: * indicates $p < .05$.)

Based on Figure 2, the most accurate conclusion is that:

- ☐ A. parents of children with disabilities reported less distress overall when they viewed the future expectancy appraisal of an event as "changeable." [6%]
- ☐ B. for either type of future expectancy appraisal, problem-focused coping resulted in lower levels of distress than emotion-focused coping. [36%]
- ☒ C. whether one coping strategy resulted in lower distress than the other depended on the future expectancy appraisal of the event. [55%]
- ☐ D. using a problem-focused coping strategy for an "unchangeable" future expectancy appraisal resulted in increased levels of distress compared to baseline. [1%]

Correct
54% answered correctly

Explanation:



Appraisal theory states that one's **appraisal** (evaluation) of a stimulus **determines** one's **emotional response**. In a **primary appraisal**, an individual classifies a stimulus as threatening, positive, or irrelevant. For stimuli deemed threatening, a **secondary appraisal** takes place in which the individual evaluates whether their resources/abilities are sufficient to cope with the stressor.

Study 2 investigated the level of distress resulting from different coping strategies, depending on whether participants viewed a threatening event (ie, primary appraisal) as "changeable" or "unchangeable" in the future (ie, an aspect of secondary appraisal).

Results (Figure 2) showed that for "unchangeable" events, average levels of distress were not significantly different between participants who used either emotion-focused or problem-focused coping. For "changeable" events, participants who used problem-focused coping experienced *significantly less* distress than those who used emotion-focused coping.

Therefore, the most accurate conclusion is that whether one coping strategy results in lower distress than the other depends on the future expectancy appraisal of the event.

(Choice A) Figure 2 does not *combine* emotion-focused and problem-focused coping for either type of appraisal (ie, changeable or unchangeable) and *compare* the overall distress levels.

(Choice B) For events viewed as "unchangeable," there was no significant difference in the level of distress resulting from emotion-focused and problem-focused coping.

(Choice D) Study 2 did not assess baseline levels of distress, so it is not possible to determine how distress changed compared to baseline.

Educational objective:

Appraisal theory states that one's evaluation of a stimulus determines one's emotional response. In a primary appraisal, an individual determines whether a stimulus is a threat, positive, or irrelevant. If it is deemed a threat, the individual evaluates whether their resources are sufficient to cope with the stressor in the secondary appraisal.

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